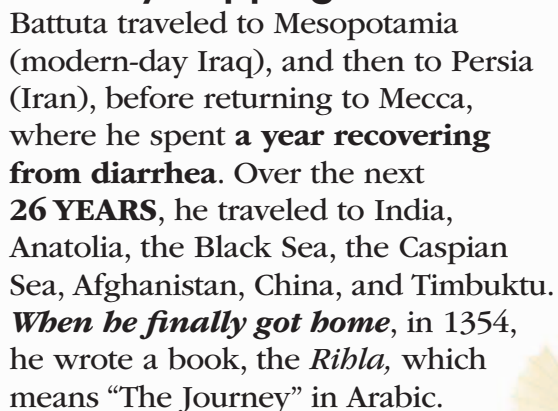


■ **IN A NUTSHELL:** My family were rich scholars. At 21, I went on "hajj," a Muslim pilgrimage to Mecca (in modern-day Saudi Arabia), the holiest city in Islam.

Battuta's journey to Mecca took him along the North African coast, through Egypt, and the Middle East (each color on the map shows a different stage of his journey). Along the way, he was **ATTACKED BY BANDITS**, fell ill, and even got married. Even though it took him **16 months to reach Mecca**, he decided he hadn't done enough traveling, so he set off for **more adventures**.



By the way...
I never traveled the same route twice, except to Mecca. When I wrote my book, many people thought my adventures couldn't be true.



The Islamic scholar who just couldn't stop TRAVELING